Samuel Yao

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Education

Northeastern University — Boston, MA
Candidate for Bachelor of Science in Business Administration — *Sep 2024 - Apr 2028*
Concentration: Finance | Minor: Data Science
Relevant Coursework: Investments, Financial Management, Advanced Programming with Data, Introduction to Databases, Linear Algebra, Information Presentation & Visualization, Financial Accounting, Managerial Accounting, Calculus 2
Awards & Activities: Beta Alpha Psi, CASE Consulting, Northeastern Consulting Group, Asian Student Union, London Scholars

Professional Experience

Focus Financial Partners — Boston, MA
Incoming Tax Analyst Co-op — *Jan 2027 - Apr 2027*

Boston Bilingual Pioneer Media — Boston, MA
Product Quality Assurance Engineer Intern — *Aug 2026 - Aug 2026*
- Managed QA workflow across feature testing, bug reproduction, and code fixes for a beta release, coordinating with engineers.
- Identified and resolved 30+ bugs during beta testing of an early-stage learning platform, submitting detailed pull requests that documented each change, the reasoning behind it, and testing steps for team review.
- Reproduced user-reported issues and used AI tools (Claude, Cursor) to trace root causes across the codebase, shortening diagnosis time.

Education Polis — Cupertino, CA
Marketing Analytics Intern — *Jun 2025 - Aug 2025*
- Conducted primary and secondary research on 200+ high school students, parents, and other tutoring centers to create a SWOT analysis that identified key market opportunities, pricing gaps, and service enhancement strategies to increase center deliverables.
- Organized and led VEX robotics camps and art workshops across three campuses, overseeing participant registration and materials while raising $500 in donations to support future operations.

Manu Real Estate — Cupertino, CA
Business Advisory Intern — *Sep 2023 - Mar 2024*
- Developed a detailed 15-page business report that analyzed current operations to pinpoint strengths and weaknesses, which resulted in a strategic plan addressing 5 key operational areas to enhance profitability and customer satisfaction.
- Presented results and growth plans to a panel of judges at California's DECA competition, qualifying for the international conference with a top 5 finish out of 50+ teams, and presented the plans to Manu Changotra for implementation.

Kalshi — New York City, NY
Student Ambassador — *Dec 2022 - May 2023*
- Led the development of over 15 viable widget designs that enhanced user engagement and platform functionality, successfully onboarding 150+ new users within 2 months through targeted outreach and educational initiatives, and received Certificates of Appreciation from both the Chamber of Commerce in Cupertino and Kalshi in recognition of community business development.
- Managed over $500 in funds to run three workshops at my high school on financial literacy and platform features, and set up a promotional pop-up stand at Santana Row to engage the local community.
- Created and presented a reflective slide deck to a panel of judges at FBLA's national leadership conference about the contributions of a project, receiving 2nd out of 100+ projects across the nation.

Leadership Experience

Beta Alpha Psi — Boston, MA
Head of Consulting — *Sep 2026 - Oct 2026*
- Assessed 9 AI finance tools across staff accounting, FP&A, and CFO-level workflows for Jayant Agro, a $250M+ Indian specialty chemicals manufacturer, scoring each on 6 criteria including cost, data security, and ease of rollout.
- Built automated finance workflows using the top-scoring tools (HighRadius, Datarails, Microsoft 365 Copilot), tailored to the client's 59% quarterly revenue swing and ∼2% net margin.
- Led a cost-benefit analysis of AI adoption covering India's lower labor costs, accountant trust concerns, and key-person risk.

Northeastern University — Boston, MA
Nimbus Peer Tutor — *Oct 2026 - Present*
- Tutored 14 students one-on-one across 40 online sessions in business and mathematics, earning a 4.8/5.0 rating from 20 reviews.
- Delivered personalized instruction in courses including Advanced Programming with Data, Statistics, Corporate Finance, and Investments, adapting methods to each student's learning style.
- Helped students strengthen problem-solving skills, build effective study strategies, and improve performance in quantitative coursework.

Algorithmic Investments and Quantitative Investments — Boston, MA
Head of Recruitment and Quantitative Research — *Sep 2025 - Mar 2026*
- Conducted quantitative research using statistical analysis and machine learning to identify market opportunities and develop algorithmic trading strategies for the investment team, which led to a top 10 finish in the CQA investment competition.
- Directed end-to-end recruitment process, screening 40+ candidates and conducting 20+ interviews to hire 5 quantitative analysts with expertise in statistical modeling and algorithmic trading strategies.

Skills & Interests

Skills: Java, Python, SQL, Tableau, Streamlit, Microsoft Excel & Word, Google Suite, Flask API, Abacus, Bloomberg, GitHub
Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Native), Korean (Elementary Proficiency)
Interests: Photography, Real Madrid Soccer, 49ers, Matcha Lattes, Lox Bagel, R&B, Backpacking, Airfryer Recipes, V4 Bouldering